

AI Calling Strategy for Ditto Insurance

Problem Statement:

Ditto Insurance is finding it hard to keep up with growing lead volumes. Many users don't get timely responses, miss scheduled consultations, or drop off during follow-ups.

This leads to lost opportunities and puts pressure on advisors handling repetitive tasks.

Company: SkilloVilla

PM Intern Case Study

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Section A: Sales Funnel Research

1. Map the Sales Funnel & Identify the Opportunity

Stage	What Happens	Conv. Rate	Main Drop-off	AI Fit?
1. Awareness	Finshots newsletter, Google, Instagram, YouTube ads.	100% (entry)	Low Ditto brand recall vs Policybazaar	Marketing problem
2. Lead Capture	User submits 'Book a Free Call' form	~5–8% of visitors	Form friction, trust gap	WhatsApp preferred
3. First Contact	Team contacts lead to confirm & schedule advisor slot	~55–65% connected	Slow response (>15 min), lead goes cold	TOP PRIORITY
4. Reminder	Advisor calls customer at scheduled time	~40–55% show up	Customer forgot; no reminder system	HIGH (reminder call)
5. Consultation	30-min IRDAI-certified advisory call	4.9★ satisfaction	Mismatched advisor expertise	MUST stay human
6. Post-consult Follow-up	Advisor shares policy options via WhatsApp	25–35% → policy	Customer distracted, delayed response	Medium — nudge after 48 hrs
7. Policy Issuance	Application, medical, payment, policy doc	~80–90%	Document delays, payment drop-off	Doc reminders only

Priority Focus: Why Stage 3

- **Speed directly impacts conversions:** Leads contacted within 5 minutes are nearly 9× more likely to convert compared to leads contacted after 30 minutes (LeadSquared). Currently, Ditto's response time often ranges between 15–60 minutes.
- **Ideal use case for AI calling:** This stage does not require deep insurance expertise. The AI only needs to confirm interest, identify whether the customer wants health or term insurance, and schedule a consultation slot. The workflow is short, structured, and repetitive.
- **Appointment reminders should be the second priority:** An AI reminder call one hour before the consultation can significantly improve attendance rates, potentially increasing showups from around 50% to over 70%. It is operationally simple and delivers strong ROI.
- **Consultation calls should remain human-led:** Ditto's strong 4.9-star reputation comes from trust-based human advisory. Replacing advisors with AI during actual consultations could negatively impact customer trust and brand perception.

Section B. platform Comparison & Recommendation

2. Research, reach out & compare AI calling Platforms.

Feature	Bland AI	Retell AI	ElevenLabs	Vapi
Pricing (Per minute)	~₹8-14/min (inbound, Base rate)	~₹5–14/min (Realistic all in cost)	₹8/min (Voice only)	~₹1- 30/min (depends on stack)
Pricing Model	Flat per-minute (includes LLM + telephony)	Usage-based (transparent bundles)	Credit-based + usage	Component-based (pay per service)
Language & voice support	Good (standard voices, optional premium)	Good + customizable voices	70+ languages, 10k+ voices	Depends on providers (high flexibility)
Key Features	Outbound/inbound calling, transcription, webhook integrations	End-to-end voice agent stack, low latency, visual builder	Best-in-class voice synthesis, real-time conversation	Modular architecture (choose LLM, STT, TTS)
Telephony (calls)	Built-in	Built-in DND check + 9AM–9PM window	Not native (needs Twilio/Plivo)	Requires external telephony
CRM Integrations	Basic (webhooks, API-based)	Strong (native + API integrations)	Limited (needs external tools)	Fully API-driven (custom integrations)
API Flexibility	Medium (limited customization)	Medium–High	High (API-first for voice)	Very High (developer-first platform)
Limitations	Limited voice realism vs premium tools	Can get costly with scale	Not a full calling platform	Complex setup, requires engineering
Best Use Case	Outbound sales, campaigns	inbound AI agents	Premium voice experience	Building custom AI voice products

Recommendation: Retell AI for Ditto's Pilot

Optimising for: fast deployment, natural conversations, reliable human handoff, and smooth CRM integration. Important for delivering a trustworthy customer experience during the pilot.

- Not choosing Vapi: As it's highly flexible but engineering heavy, over kill for early stage AI pilots.
- Bland AI as an A/B option: Good for outbound scale and script testing, but less flexible for insurance conversations.
- Not choosing ElevenLabs: Excellent voice quality but lack built in telephony and workflow.

Section C: Designing the AI Caller

3. AI Caller Persona & Call Script

Persona: Arush

Meet “Arush” - Ditto’s AI caller assistant- calm, Hinglish friendly and genuinely helpful. He’s not a salesperson but AI, Arush speaks like a knowledgeable friend who wants to make sure you’re covered, and he stays under 2min, always ends with a confirmed next step.

Call Script — Stage 3: First Contact (triggers within 90 seconds of form submission)

[Call connects]

Arush: Hi, am I speaking with (Mr. Charan)?

Customer: Yeah...

Arush: This is Arush from Ditto Insurance - I’m ditto’s AI assistant. You recently booked a call on our website, and I’m reaching out to quickly confirm and schedule your slot. It’ll only take minute. Is that okay?

Customer: yes

Arush: Great!! Are you looking for health insurance, term insurance or else both?

Customer: responded

Arush: Okay got it, that helps. we have slots for tomorrow at 10 AM or 6 PM, which works better for you?"

Customer: Picks up a slot for the confirmation.

Arush: Awesome, I’ve booked that for you! You’ll receive a confirmation on WhatsApp shortly. Also, is there anything specific you’d like the advisor to focus on during the call?

Customer: Responds/ Says no.

Arush: Noted, see you tomorrow at 10AM, Charan. Thank you have a great day!

~ (45 seconds of AI speaking time)

4.Edge Cases

Category / Trigger	What Customer Says / Behaviour	AI Response	Outcomes
Busy / bad time	I'm in a meeting / Call later	Of course! Would this evening or tomorrow morning work better? → capture preferred time	Schedule retry. Max 1 retry per lead per 24 hrs (Ditto no-spam rule)
Hesitant / just browsing	I'm not sure I need this	No pressure, our advisors will explain the options, never push. Even a 10-min call might help you. Want to try? → if still no: send WhatsApp resource link	Log as nurture. No follow-up call.
No answer	Phone rings but no pickup	Don't leave voicemail. Send WhatsApp message immediately. "Hi [Name] we tried reaching out from Ditto Insurance. Please book your slot here [Link]"	Retry calling next day at the different time slot.
Angry / Stop calling	This is spam! / How'd you get my number?'	Completely understand, you submitted a request on joinditto.in. I'll make sure you're not contacted again. Sorry for the trouble. → end call immediately	Add to DNC list instantly; WhatsApp apology with opt-out confirmation.
Medical / complex question	My father has diabetes, which policy covers this?	That's an important question for our advisors, let me book you a slot now. → do NOT attempt to answer	Escalate, the question in advisor notes.
Language switch	Switches to Hindi mid-call	If Hindi/Hinglish: auto-switch to Hindi. If regional language beyond capability: 'Main ek advisor se connect karta hoon jo aapki language mein baat kar sake.	Hindi: continue. Regional language- escalate to multilingual advisor.
Urgency / distress	My parent is in hospital; I need insurance now	I'm so sorry, wait let me connect you to our advisor right now. → live transfer or immediate escalation with URGENT flag	Priority queue; human calls back within 15 min

Section D: Execution Plan

5. Step by Step Execution Plan

Steps	Phase	What Happens/ Key Actions	Who's Involved	Dependencies
1	Pilot Goal	Finalize what the AI should do: call confirmation, insurance type selection, slot scheduling, and human handoff. Keep scope intentionally narrow.	PM, Operations Team, Sales Team	Clear success metrics needed before build (pickup rate, booking confirmation %, handoff rate).
2	Vendor Evaluation Define & Setup	Finalize Retell AI, understand pricing/API limits, purchase numbers, and configure telephony setup.	PM, Engineering, Vendor Team	Depends on compliance checks and estimated call volumes.
3	Conversation Design	Write conversational scripts in a human, non-spam tone. Add fallback responses and escalation logic for confused/frustrated users.	PM, Content/Support Team	Script should reflect Ditto's trust-first brand voice.
3-4	Human Handoff Flow	Define when AI transfers to a human agent (complex questions, repeated confusion, policy specific doubts).	Ops Team, CRM Team	Requires advisor availability + routing logic.
5	CRM & Workflow Integration	Connect Retell AI with CRM/calendar tools to fetch leads, schedule slots, and log call outcomes automatically.	Engineering Team	API access + clean CRM data required.
6	Internal Testing	Run mock calls internally to test latency, interruptions, pronunciation, and edge cases.	PM, QA Team, Internal Employees	Fix robotic pauses and broken flows before real users.
7	Pilot Launch (Small Batch)	Start with a limited user group (ex: 100–500 leads/day) instead of full rollout	PM, Operations, Support Team	Human monitoring failure cases closely during first few days.
8	Calling Time Optimization	Experiment with call timings (10AM- 1PM & evening till 8PM) and measure pickup/conversion rates. Avoid spam calling 1-2 PM (Lunch Break)	PM, Analytics Team	Time-of- day insights will directly impact pilot success.
9	Measure & iterate	Track metrics: pickup rate, completion rate, human handoff %, booking success, user sentiment. Improve scripts weekly.	PM, Analytics, Support Team	Continuous iteration is more important than scaling fast.
10	Scale Decision	If pilot performs well, expand use cases: reminders, policy renewal follow-ups, multilingual support.	Leadership, PM, Engineering	Scale only after reliability and customer trust are validated.

6. Input & Output Data Formats:

Input Data Format (JSON from CRM webhook)		Output Data Format (JSON written back to CRM)	
Field	Purpose	Field	Purpose
Lead-id	Unique identifier for each customer	Call ID	Unique ID for tracking calls
Name	Used for personalized conversation	Lead ID	Maps call back to customer
Phone	Number AI caller with dial	Call timestamp	Records exact call time
Email-id	For CRM tracking and follow up	Call duration in seconds	Measures engagement quality
Insurance-Type	Helps AI understand customer Need	Call outcomes	Final disposition of the call
Lead- Source	Helps measure campaign quality	Language Detection	Helps improve multilingual routs
Form submission	Useful for prioritize the leads	Conversation Rating	Measure customer satisfaction via rating
Language Preferred	Helps AI to assist the language preference	Scheduled slot	Stores booking consultation timing
DND Status	Prevents calling restricted users	Customer query updates	Takes customer concerns
Call Status	Tracks the current workflow	Escalation Flag/ Reason	Marks need for human support & explains why
N/A	N/A	Transcript URL	Stores full call script
N/A	N/A	WhatsApp Confirmation Status	Tracks follow up automation and updates

7. KPI'S

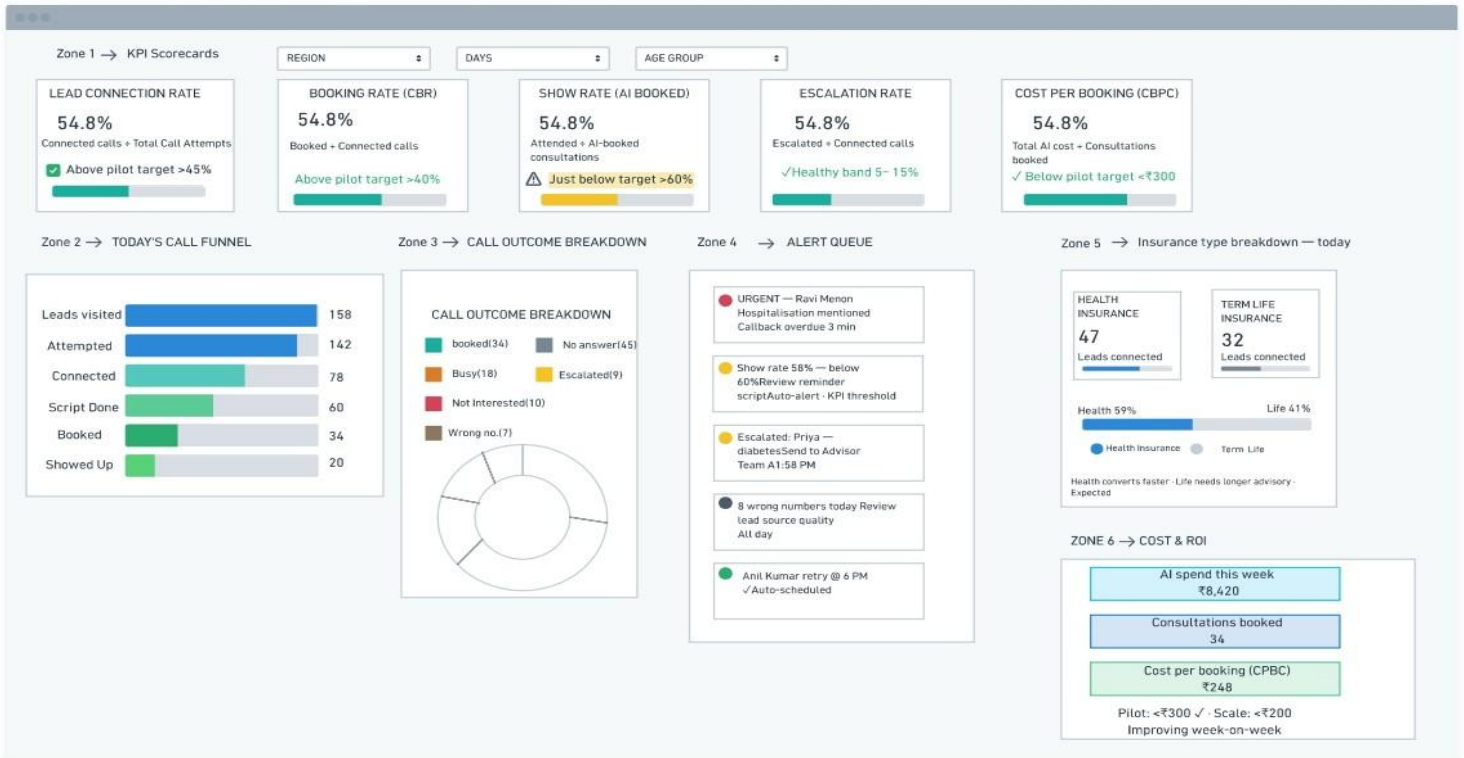
KPI	Why It Matters	Formula	Target (Pilot → Scale) (Estimated values)
1. Lead Connect Rate	If people aren't even picking the call, the rest flow doesn't matter. A low connect rate = poor calling timing or weak opening lines.	$\text{Connected calls} \div \text{Total Call Attempts}$	>45% → >55%
2. Consultation Booking Rate (CBR)	This is the main success metric. It shows whether the AI conversation is convincing users to book a consultation.	$\text{Consultation Booked} \div \text{Connected calls}$	>40% → >50%
3. Show Rate (AI-booked)	Booking only matters when the customer attends call for consultation. A performance must match or beat it human booked show rates.	$\text{Attended consultation} \div \text{AI-booked consultation}$	>60% → >70%
4. Escalation Rate	Too low = AI mishandling complex calls. Too high = AI not working. Too many escalations mean weak AI handling.	$\text{Calls Escalated to human} \div \text{connected calls}$	5–15% (healthy band)
5. Cost Per Booked Consult (CPBC)	The ROI metric. It helps determine whether AI calling is more Total cost efficient than manual follow ups by advisors.	$\text{Total AI calling cost} \div \text{Bookings}$	<₹300 → <₹200

Section E: Dashboard & Monitoring

8. Sales Manager Dashboard

Sample Wireframes: [Sales manager Dashboard Wireframe](#)

Arush Operations Center Ditto Insurance - AI voice Calling Dashboard (Sales Manager View)



Trade- offs Made:

- **Retell AI over Vapi:** Vapi offers very high flexibility and deep customization, but it requires significant engineering effort and longer setup time. For Ditto's pilot, the priority is fast deployment and operational reliability rather than building a fully custom AI infrastructure from scratch.
- **Retell AI over ElevenLabs:** ElevenLabs provides industry-leading voice quality, but it is primarily a voice synthesis platform and lacks built-in telephony and complete calling workflows. Ditto needs an end-to-end AI calling solution with scheduling, call handling, and CRM integration ready for production use.
- **Bland AI kept as an A/B testing option:** Bland AI is strong for outbound campaigns and scalable scripted calls, but insurance conversations require smoother handoffs, contextual handling, and better workflow control. Retell AI is better suited for trust-oriented customer interactions during the pilot stage.
- **AI scope intentionally limited to scheduling and reminders:** It may be tempting to let the AI explain policies or recommend plans, but Ditto's strongest differentiator is its human-led advisory experience. The AI is only handling repetitive operational tasks to improve efficiency without affecting customer trust.
- **Pilot focused on reliability before scale:** Instead of optimizing immediately for maximum automation or lowest cost, the pilot prioritizes conversation quality, CRM visibility, and human escalation workflows. Once these are validated, Ditto can gradually expand automation scope and optimize costs at scale.

If I Had More Time:

- **Deeper vendor validation:** I would directly connect with Retell AI, Bland AI, and Vapi sales teams to collect detailed pricing breakdowns, latency benchmarks, and real deployment case studies. This would help validate platform scalability and hidden operational costs before production rollout.
- **Regional language optimization:** I would create localized scripts in Telugu, Tamil, and Bengali along with Hinglish variations. Since Ditto is expanding beyond metro users, regional personalization could significantly improve connection rates and customer comfort.
- **A/B testing of scripts and call timings:** I would experiment with different introductions, reminder phrasing, and calling windows (morning vs evening) to identify which combinations drive the highest consultation booking and show-up rates.

Sources:

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